

MySQL Latest Free Version Install and Local Database Setup

Windows-focused guide for installing MySQL Community Server and configuring this Spring Boot project to use a local MySQL database.

Current Official Version

As of June 17, 2026, Oracle's MySQL Community download page lists **MySQL Community Server 9.7.1 LTS** as the latest free Community Server release for Windows.

Download page: <https://dev.mysql.com/downloads/mysql/>

Important: the old MySQL Installer wizard is only for MySQL 8.0. For MySQL 8.1 and newer, use the product MSI or ZIP archive. The server MSI includes MySQL Configurator.

Download And Install

1. Go to <https://dev.mysql.com/downloads/mysql/>.
2. Select Version: 9.7.1 LTS.
3. Select Operating System: Microsoft Windows.
4. Select OS Version: All Windows (x86, 64-bit).
5. Download the Windows MSI Installer, named similar to `mysql-9.7.1-winx64.msi`.
6. If Oracle asks you to sign in, choose No thanks, just start my download.
7. Run the MSI as Administrator.
8. When installation finishes, launch MySQL Configurator immediately.

MySQL Configurator Settings

- Configuration type: Development Computer.
- Connectivity: TCP/IP enabled.
- Port: 3306.
- Firewall: opening the port is optional for local-only development.

- Authentication: strong password encryption.
- Root password: choose and save a strong password.
- Windows Service: enabled.
- Service name: usually MySQL97 or similar.
- Start MySQL Server at system startup: yes.

Verify The Install

```
mysql --version  
mysql -u root -p
```

If mysql is not recognized, add this folder to your Windows PATH, then open a new PowerShell window:

```
C:\Program Files\MySQL\MySQL Server 9.7\bin
```

Create Local Database And App User

Log in as root:

```
mysql -u root -p
```

Run the following SQL:

```
CREATE DATABASE immiauto  
  
    CHARACTER SET utf8mb4  
  
    COLLATE utf8mb4_0900_ai_ci;  
  
CREATE USER 'immiauto_user'@'localhost'  
  
    IDENTIFIED BY 'ChangeThisStrongPassword123!';  
  
GRANT ALL PRIVILEGES ON immiauto.* TO 'immiauto_user'@'localhost';  
  
FLUSH PRIVILEGES;
```

Test the new app user:

```
mysql -u immiauto_user -p -h localhost -P 3306 immiauto
```

Spring Boot Project Configuration

This project currently uses H2 in backend/src/main/resources/application.properties. To use MySQL locally, add the MySQL JDBC driver and update the datasource settings.

Add this dependency to backend/pom.xml:

```
<dependency>

    <groupId>com.mysql</groupId>

    <artifactId>mysql-connector-j</artifactId>

    <scope>runtime</scope>

</dependency>
```

Use these application.properties database settings:

```
spring.datasource.url=jdbc:mysql://localhost:3306/immiauto?useSSL=false&allowPublicKeyR
etrieval=true&serverTimezone=UTC

spring.datasource.driver-class-name=com.mysql.cj.jdbc.Driver

spring.datasource.username=immiauto_user

spring.datasource.password=ChangeThisStrongPassword123!


spring.jpa.hibernate.ddl-auto=update

spring.jpa.show-sql=true

spring.jpa.properties.hibernate.format_sql=true

spring.jpa.properties.hibernate.dialect=org.hibernate.dialect.MySQLDialect


spring.h2.console.enabled=false
```

Run The Backend

```
cd C:\Users\mh200\Projects\Immigration-Consultation\backend

.\mvnw spring-boot:run
```

Connection Summary

```
Host: localhost  
Port: 3306  
Database: immiauto  
Username: immiauto_user  
Password: ChangeThisStrongPassword123!  
JDBC URL: jdbc:mysql://localhost:3306/immiauto?useSSL=false&allowPublicKeyRetrieval=true&serverTimezone=UTC
```

Use the dedicated immiauto_user for the application. Keep root only for administration.

Official References

MySQL Community Server downloads: <https://dev.mysql.com/downloads/mysql/>

MySQL Installer note: <https://dev.mysql.com/downloads/installer/>

MySQL Windows installation docs: <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/9.7/en/windows-installation.html>